Terms & Assumptions, Defined Up Front

KEY TERMS

MRR

Monthly Recurring Revenue — the subscription revenue a company can count on collecting every month.

30-day revenue

Total cash collected in the last 30 days — a snapshot of current momentum, not just subscriptions.

Growth rate (30-day)

% change in revenue vs. the prior 30 days — our best available speed gauge.

Revenue multiple

Asking price of a business for sale, expressed in years of revenue (e.g. “3x” = priced at ~3 years of revenue).

On-sale rate

% of companies in a category currently listed for sale — a rough proxy for how many owners want out.

Attractiveness score

Our own model (this deck) blending size, growth, deal economics, resale value & crowding into one rank.

ASSUMPTIONS WE'RE MAKING

- Data source: TrustMRR — founders voluntarily list their (often Stripe-verified) revenue. Snapshot frozen 30 Jul 2026.
- This is a sample, not a census: 1,000 companies skew toward indie/bootstrapped founders who chose to go public with numbers — not the full global market.
- “Market size” here = revenue actually flowing through these 1,000 companies. It's a directional proxy for opportunity, not an official industry TAM figure.
- Category & country are self-reported by founders — about 1 in 4 rows has no country tag, and 1 in 4 has no category tag.
- Our attractiveness score weights: Size 30% · Growth 25% · Deal economics 20% · Resale value 15% · Low crowding 10% — a judgment call, stated so it can be challenged.

Source: TrustMRR 1,000-company dataset, frozen 30 Jul 2026 — analysis by founder's team

Where should the founder build?

Marketing software, sold to US-based business customers, is the strongest entry point the data can defend. AI is the biggest prize — but also the most contested.

#1 Marketing

42 companies · $1.3M/mo tracked revenue · 3.70x median resale multiple — best risk-adjusted score among categories with a credible sample size.

AI = biggest pie

$2.36M/mo across 197 companies — largest market by far, but also the most crowded: lowest “competitive ease” score of any major category.

US = the customer base

63% of all tracked revenue sits with US-based companies, regardless of category — the default first market.

Analytics & E-comm: watchlist

Score even higher (0.80 / 0.78) than Marketing — but only 19 companies each. Promising, not yet provable.

SO WHAT: Build a marketing tool and sell to US business customers first — it's the best-tested combination of size, growth and resale value in the data. AI is the bigger long-run prize only if the founder can genuinely out-differentiate 197 existing players.

APPROACH

What We Tested, and How

We scored every product category in the dataset with ≥10 tracked companies (18 of 29 categories cleared that bar) across five dimensions:

30%

Market Size

Total 30-day revenue across all tracked companies in the category

25%

Growth

Median 30-day revenue growth rate

20%

Deal Economics

Average MRR per company — how much a typical customer relationship is worth

15%

Resale Value

Median revenue multiple among companies listed for sale

10%

Low Crowding

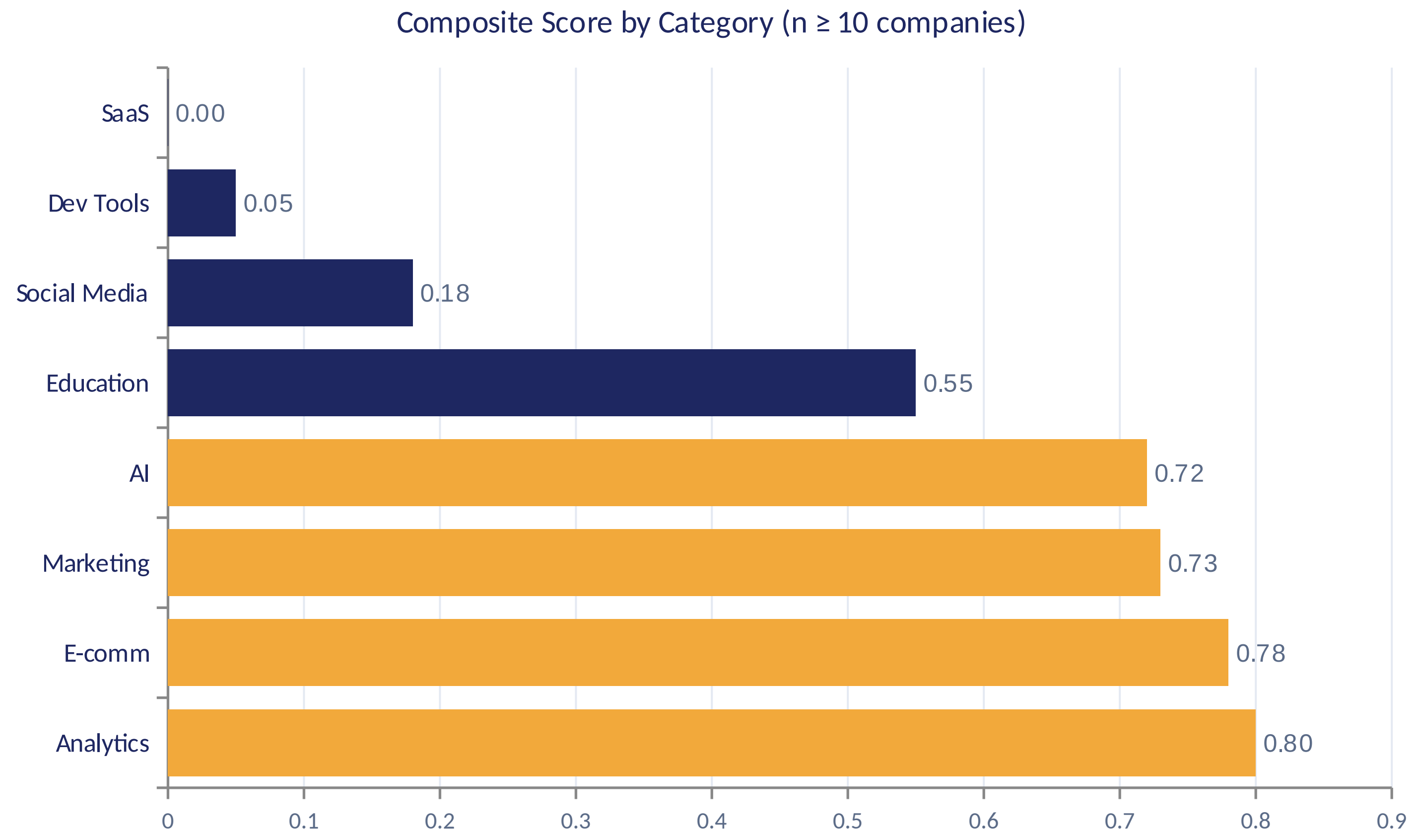
Fewer tracked competitors = an easier category to stand out in

Excluded from ranking: 11 categories with fewer than 10 tracked companies (e.g. Legal, Crypto & Web3, News & Magazines — down to a single company each). One or two data points can't support a market call, so we flag these as unrankable rather than force a score.

SO WHAT: We only rank categories with enough companies behind the number to trust it — below 10 companies, a ranking is a coin flip, not a market signal.

Source: TrustMRR 1,000-company dataset, frozen 30 Jul 2026 — analysis by founder's team

Industry Attractiveness Scorecard



Content Creation & Health/Fitness score negative (-0.12, -0.16) and are omitted here for clarity.

TOP 4 AT A GLANCE

Category	Cos.	Score
Analytics	19	0.80
E-comm	19	0.78
Marketing	42	0.73
AI	197	0.72

Read this carefully: the top 4 categories are a statistical cluster (0.72–0.80) — not a clean 1-2-3-4. Analytics and E-comm score highest but rest on just 19 companies each. Marketing (42 cos.) and AI (197 cos.) are the confident, well-populated bets.

SO WHAT: Four categories cluster at the top — Analytics, E-comm, Marketing, AI. Everything from Education downward is a materially weaker bet on this data.

Deep Dive: AI — The Biggest Market, The Most Crowded

197
companies tracked

$2.36M
combined 30-day revenue — largest of any category

$11,963
avg. revenue per company / month

0%
median 30-day growth — flat, not falling

27%
of AI companies currently listed for sale

3.15x
median resale multiple for AI businesses on sale

Why AI ranks 4th, not 1st, on our score: the revenue is real and the biggest pie in the dataset — but it's split across 197 competitors, giving AI the lowest “competitive ease” sub-score of any major category. Bigger market, harder to stand out in.

SO WHAT: AI is the market to be in for scale — but only with a sharp wedge; going in generically means competing with 197 tracked players already fighting for the same $2.36M/month.

Source: TrustMRR 1,000-company dataset, frozen 30 Jul 2026 — analysis by founder's team

Deep Dive: The “Goldilocks” Tier

	Marketing	E-comm	Analytics
Companies tracked	42	19	19
Combined 30-day revenue	$1.32M	$1.11M	$368K
Avg. deal size (MRR/company)	$10,583	$20,829	$18,831
Median 30-day growth	+0.95%	0.0%	+4.9%
Median resale multiple	**3.70x**	2.05x	3.40x
Sample confidence	**Moderate**	Thin	Thin

Marketing

Largest, most credible sample among the three. Strongest resale multiple — buyers pay up for these businesses.

E-comm

Highest average deal size per company — but flat growth and the weakest resale multiple of the tier.

Analytics

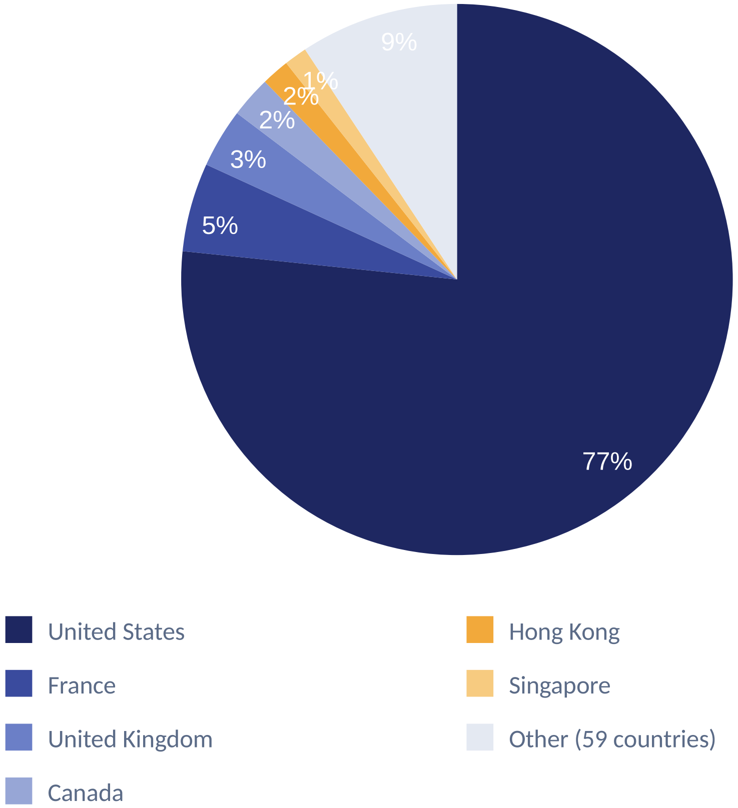
Fastest median growth and a strong multiple — but only 19 companies back this number; treat as a lead, not a conclusion.

SO WHAT: Marketing is the standout when you weigh reward against sample confidence; E-comm and Analytics are real leads worth a pilot, not yet a full commitment.

Source: TrustMRR 1,000-company dataset, frozen 30 Jul 2026 — analysis by founder's team

Where Are the Paying Customers?

Revenue by Country (companies with a country tag)



US = 77% of country-tagged revenue

(63% of the full 1,000-company dataset — the gap is because ~24% of rows carry no country tag.) Whatever category the founder picks, the customers most likely to pay — and pay the most — are US-based.

A DATA POINT WORTH A SECOND LOOK: INDIA

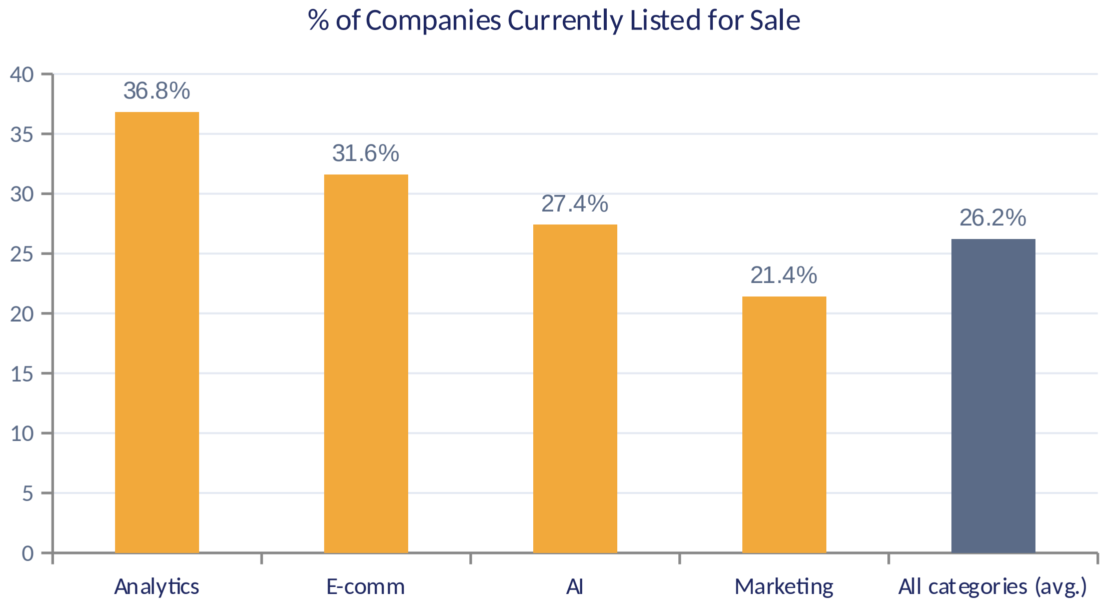
59 India-based companies are tracked in this dataset, totaling just $140,946/month in combined revenue — less than 1.5% of what the US alone generates.

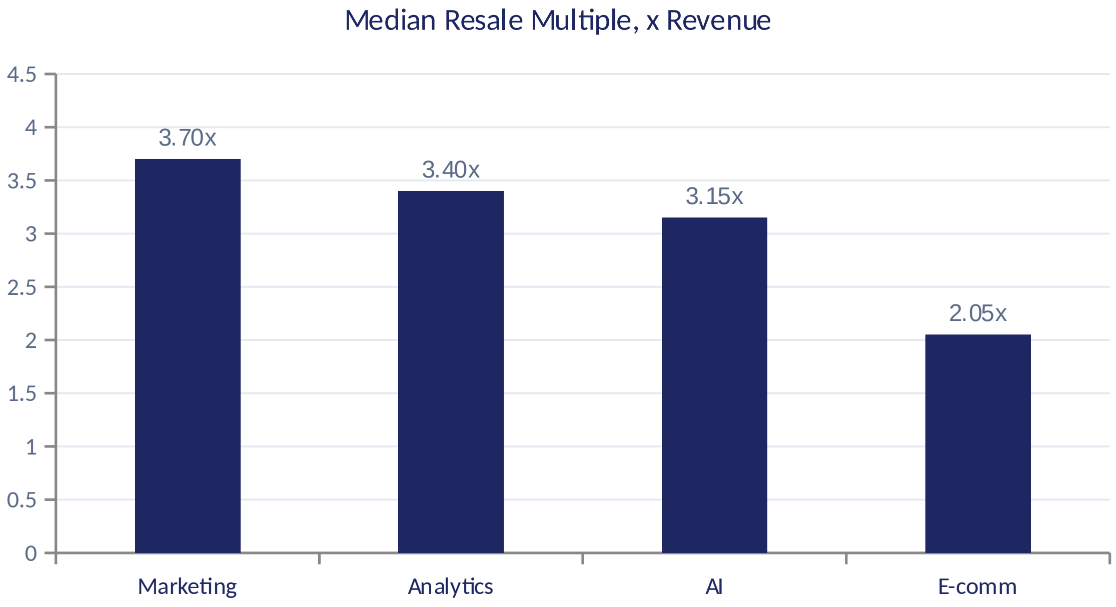
In AI specifically: Indian AI companies average $2,794/month in revenue, versus $29,156/month for US AI companies — roughly a 10x gap per company.

SO WHAT: Wherever the founder is based, build for US buyers first — in this sample, the same product monetizes roughly 10x better per customer in the US than in India.

Source: TrustMRR 1,000-company dataset, frozen 30 Jul 2026 — analysis by founder's team

Competitive Intensity & Exit Signals





How to read “on-sale rate”: it cuts both ways — a high rate can mean a mature, flippable market (good, if you want to buy rather than build) or founder fatigue (a caution flag). Pair it with the growth numbers on Slide 6 before drawing a conclusion.

SO WHAT: Marketing wins on both counts — the lowest exit rate (least owner fatigue) and the highest resale multiple (most buyer confidence) of the four leading categories.

Source: TrustMRR 1,000-company dataset, frozen 30 Jul 2026 — analysis by founder's team

WHERE THIS COULD BREAK

Risks & Assumptions

1

Self-selection bias

The dataset only includes founders willing to publicize their numbers — it likely undercounts large, VC-backed or enterprise AI players who don't list on TrustMRR.

2

Thin samples can flip

Analytics and E-comm rest on just 19 companies each. Five to ten more data points could reorder the top of the scorecard.

3

30-day noise

A single month includes outliers — a few companies show 500%+ growth off a tiny prior-month base. Treat any single triple-digit figure with suspicion.

4

Missing tags

~1 in 4 companies has no country tag and ~1 in 4 has no category tag — self-reported, not verified.

5

Our scoring weights are a judgment call

30/25/20/15/10% is defensible, not definitive. Re-weighting toward pure growth, for instance, would push Analytics and Dev Tools higher.

6

Revenue ≠ total addressable market

This measures revenue already captured by existing players, not untapped demand. A category could rank low here simply because no one has cracked it yet.

SO WHAT: None of these risks change the direction of the recommendation — but they should shrink the founder's confidence in the exact ranking, especially below Marketing and AI.

Source: TrustMRR 1,000-company dataset, frozen 30 Jul 2026 — analysis by founder's team

FINAL RECOMMENDATIONS

Ranked Recommendations & Next Steps

1

Build in Marketing, sell to US B2B buyers first

Best-evidenced risk/reward: credible sample (42 cos.), healthy growth, strongest resale multiple (3.70x) of any leading category.

High feasibility · High impact

2

Treat AI as the long-run prize — only with a real wedge

Largest market ($2.36M/mo) but most crowded (197 competitors). Validate a differentiated angle before committing.

High impact · High difficulty

3

Pilot Analytics or E-comm before full commitment

Both score higher than Marketing on paper, but on just 19 companies each. A lead worth testing, not a market to bet the company on.

Moderate impact · Low confidence

IMMEDIATE NEXT STEPS

1. Run a landing-page / ad test targeting US Marketing-software buyers to validate real demand before writing code.
2. Cross-check category TAM against an independent industry report — this dataset proxies captured revenue, not total demand.
3. Interview 10–15 target US Marketing-software buyers to pressure-test the wedge before full build commitment.

ABOUT THIS ANALYSIS

Note on This Engagement

ASSUMED CONTEXT

It is assumed that my manager asked me to analyze the attached dataset on behalf of a founder who is looking to build a new product and is still deciding which industry to enter. The founder has not looked at the underlying data before, so every term, number, and assumption in this deck was explained in plain language rather than assumed — see Slide 1.

Deliverable: a ranked, evidence-based recommendation on which product category to build in and which country to target first — built entirely from the 1,000-company TrustMRR dataset provided, with risks and assumptions stated explicitly on Slide 9.

REQUESTED BY	PREPARED FOR	DATA SOURCE
Reporting manager	Founder — early-stage, product/industry still TBD	TrustMRR, 1,000 companies, frozen 30 Jul 2026